

Samuel Cole



Founding engineer and CTO. I make things from scratch.

Experience

6. LEMONTREE

CTO 2021–present

Transformed a NYC helpline serving a handful of people a day into a food access system helping over a million across 11 regions in 2025. Built an LLM pipeline (Gemini Flash) that 2.5x'd call volume for a 3-5 person team across Pakistan, Philippines, Kenya. Mentored an engineer; owned strategy, budget, and infrastructure.

5. ACTBLUE

Senior Software Engineer 2017–2021

At the Democratic fundraising platform: rewrote the main donation form server (Ruby Sinatra → Node; ops later lifted it to AWS unchanged) and the company's PCI tokenizer. Solo, built a new embed from scratch at 100% test coverage.

Contributions scaled from ~\$1B to over \$8B. Embed powered the Biden presidential campaign, the NAACP, Everytown, and more.

4. ABACUS

Full Stack Engineer 2015–2017

One of 5 engineers building tools for enterprises to manage employee spending. Shipped receipt view, a redesigned search and faceting system, automated flight metadata, and trip-level grouping. Acquired by Emburse.

3. JUKELY

Lead Web Engineer 2014–2015

Employee #8 at a live-music subscription startup. Built the client-side app from scratch in React / webpack / Reflux; contributed to the Rails API, including the company's first Stripe integration. When the CEO announced a Canada launch a week out with no code written, shipped full-stack currency and localization, on time.

2. KICKSTARTER

Software Engineer 2010–2014

Employee #12, one of the first two full-time engineers; joined pre-launch. Owned the client side as Kickstarter scaled from \$28M in annual pledges to crossing \$1B cumulative (March 2014), with 22,000+ projects funded in 2014 alone. Built the front-end of the multistep project editor (still the basic shape of today's flow), site search, custom text editors, creator messaging/backer tools, admin tooling, and the first mainstream HTML5 video player.

1. PATCH

Front End Web Engineer 2008–2010

First front-end engineer; joined before the company had a name. Built the CMS and front-end architecture that scaled to hundreds of small-town news sites across America, plus a system for rendering highly customized neighborhood maps. Acquired by AOL.

Education

0. ROCHESTER INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

B.S., Multidisciplinary Studies: Computer Science & Literature; minor in Creative Writing

2004 – 2008

Skills

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript · Node.js · Next.js · React · Ruby on Rails

Infra & Data: Postgres · Prisma · Redis · AWS (RDS, ECS) · Vercel · GitHub Actions · ETL pipelines

APIs & AI: Mapbox · Twilio · Google Cloud · Vertex AI (Gemini) · AI SDK · LLM agents

Contact Information

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